

Streamlining Combat (May & June 2025)

Underlying Concepts & Terms

- Melee is an Opposed Roll
- Each combatant chooses their Approach to the engagement

Approach = a tactic, style or attitude the combatant uses this round

- An approach has a guaranteed benefit, and a variable benefit depending on the width of the dice pool roll. Rolling a triple or more of a number which is less than the target attribute. e.g. rolling triple 2's with an Agility of 3.

Width = the count of the same number result in the dice pool roll e.g. three of the same number equals a triple of that number.

Lowest, Widest = the lower of any tied widest results. e.g. triple of 2's and 1's would take the 1's

- An approach can modify the number of successes or generate Advantages or other modifiers.

Advantages = opportunity to modify the outcome, apply special moves, actions or reactions.

- Net Successes determine the winner, with momentum resolving a tie in the modified roll result
- Net Successes also determine the basic wound points inflicted. The weight/type of the weapon's grip converts successes into wound points. e.g. a knife is a light weapon, where 1, 2 or 3 successes create a 1pt wound, but 4 successes causes a 2pt wound.

Wound points = the damage caused

Grip = some weapons can be held and used in different ways. A Grip determines the effective reach and weight of the weapon as well as the special effects which it can trigger. e.g. a cutlass could be used 'at guard' grip for 'Melee' distance and as a 'Heavy' weapon, or at a 'pommel' grip for use 'Up Close', and as a 'Light' weight blow.

Momentum

Stagger

Missile is Unopposed, resolved in Speed sequence

- Range, target size and movement plus conditions represent the Rd 'effective opposition'

Sequence

1. Approach

2. Roll & Outcome

3. Advantages

The Approach to Combat

1. Narrative situation determines starting position

1. Distance

2. Surprise

3. Establishing who has **Momentum**, if narrative doesn't determine, then calculate combined speed to determine momentum order

1. Highest speed wins momentum

2. Ties to Actors

2. Each opponent declares their **Approach** for the round

1. Declare in speed order or the order which makes sense for the narrative

2. Establishing who has **Momentum**, if narrative doesn't determine

1. Speed + Approach modifier

2. Highest speed wins momentum

3. Ties to Actors

3. **Movement** before the resolution roll

1. In speed order, any combatant that has a Step can use it to change the range

2. This continues in sequence if more moves available.

4. **Resolve in reverse momentum order**

1. Declare grip

2. Check **Widest result** $\leq$ **Attribute** to determines variable outcome

1. A single or pair will fail to achieve the intent of the approach

2. A triple will achieve the intent of the approach

3. A quad or higher will achieve a strong result

4. 6's always count as successes

3. Keep or Use **Advantages**

1. Earned from success of roll vs Approach

2. Purchased with Drama pts or by reducing Successes

5. **Create the pools**

1. Choose skill used to oppose the opponent

1. Strike -> weapon strike

2. Brawl -> unarmed strike

3. Athletics -> evasion

4. Strength & Stamina -> grapple

5. Ranged -> shoot

2. Calculate Bd & Rd

1. Inc Situational modifiers
2. Inc modifiers from the Weapon & Grip choice vs Distance/Positioning
3. Inc Stagger modifiers
4. Carry any negative Rd into positive Bd (e.g. -1Rd = +1Bd)

6. Calculate the Outcome

Table of Approaches

Name	Requirements	ATT	Speed	Advantages before roll in reverse speed/momentum sequences & notes	Fail	Minor	Success	Strong
		≤ ATT			No Pair ≤ATT	Pair ≤ATT	Trip ≤ATT	≥ Quad ≤ATT
Fight/Neutral		PHY/AGL	--	Optional <u>Step</u> if not surprised and on foot, not held	0 Advantages	1 Advantage	2 Advantages	3(+) Advantages
Scramble (defend)	Use Athletics to oppose roll note: Winning doesn't change momentum	AGL	--	Optional <u>Recover</u> No attack (no distance or stagger Rd mod)	1 Advantage & -1 Momentum (applied immediately)	1 Advantage & +Step or Recover	2 Advantages & +Step or Recover	2(+) Advantages & +2 Steps or Recovers & +1 Momentum
Wary (cautious approach & parry)		PHY/AGL	-2	Min net successes = 0	-1 Successes & Optional <u>Step</u>	<u>Parry</u> & Optional <u>Step</u>	<u>Parry +1Ad</u> & +1 Advantage & Optional <u>Step</u>	<u>Parry +2Ad</u> & 2(+) Advantages & Optional <u>Step</u>
Rush in (move in & stagger)	From 'Beyond' or 'Distanced' Reach On Feet	Phy	+2	2 Steps closer, taken as one action. Try to move to <u>Up Close</u> (up to max 3 steps)	<u>Step</u> closer if not at Up Close & + <u>Staggered 2</u> (negative)	<u>Step</u> closer if not at Up Close & + <u>Stagger</u> Opponent	<u>Step</u> closer if not at Up Close & + <u>Stagger</u> Opponent & 1 Advantage	<u>Step</u> closer if not at Up Close & + <u>Double Stagger</u> Opponent & 2(+) <u>Advantages</u>

Name	Requirements	ATT	Speed	Advantages before roll in reverse speed/momentum sequences & notes	Fail	Minor	Success	Strong
Fierce (risk reward for extra damage)		PHY	+2		Use Limited Weight for Damage & -1 Momentum	Use 1 step lower Weight for Damage & 1 Advantage	<u>Inflct +1 Wound pt</u> on any one wound inflicted & 1 Advantage	<u>Inflct +2(+). Wound pt(s).</u> & +Stagger Opponent & +1(+) Advantage(s) & Momentum +1
Press (step closer & grab momentum)	On Feet	PHY	+2	<u>Step closer</u>	Momentum -1	1 Advantage	Momentum +1 & +1 Advantage	Momentum +2 & +1(+) Advantages
Brace (defend for armor stoppage)		PHY	-2	Optional <u>Recover</u>	<u>+Staggered</u> (negative)	+1 pt Block	+2pts Block & +1 Advantage	+2pts Block & Steal Momentum
Feint ('surprise' move for advantages)	On Feet, not held	AGL	-2	Optional <u>Step</u>	-2 Successes	-1 Success & +2 Advantages	+2 Successes & +2 Advantages	+2 Momentum & +2(+) Advantages
Quick (fast for advantage)		AGL	+4	Optional quick action	-1 Momentum	+2 Advantages	+1 Momentum & +2 Advantages	+1 Momentum & +3(+) Advantages
Evade (move and reduce damage)	On Feet, not held	AGL	--	<u>Optional Step</u> as last action chosen	-1 Success & -1 Momentum	Both use max <u>Light</u> Damage & +1 Advantage	Both use <u>Limited</u> Damage & Opponent causes no specials & +2 Advantages	Both use <u>Limited</u> Damage & Opponent causes no specials & +3(+) Advantages

Name	Requirements	ATT	Speed	Advantages before roll in reverse speed/momentum sequences & notes	Fail	Minor	Success	Strong
Grapple		PHY	--			Free Break or Hold & 1 Advantage	Free Break or Hold & 2 Advantages	Free Break or Hold & 3(+) Advantages
Unarmed Brawl		Phy	--	Free Target Location				
Split Attacks	Combined with a choice of Approach for each attack	AGL	n/a	1st +2 Rd 2nd +4 Rd 3rd +6 Rd				
Unopposed vs active opponent				Lose Momentum				
Surprise vs aware target				Steal Momentum -2Rd				
Surprise vs unaware target				Steal Momentum -4Rd				
Aimed Shot		AGL	-6	-2Rd		-1 Success & 1 Advantages	2 Advantages	+1 Success & 2 Advantages

TBD where movement is blocked, e.g. already up close, but someone moves away and you have a pre-move step. Should not lose the step, keep asking until everyone has nothing remaining or both skip.

All momentum changes are applied immediately

Opponent causes no specials -> crush/cut etc. Evade effectively puts the opponents at a reach which doesn't allow specials...

add a line to explain the goal and risk/reward for each approach

Positioning/Range Modifier table

At chosen Grip Weapon Reach	Up Close Range	Melee Distance	At Distance Range
Unarmed	n/a	4Rd	6Rd

At chosen Grip Weapon Reach	Up Close Range	Melee Distance	At Distance Range
Up Close	n/a	1Rd	4Rd
Melee	2Rd	n/a	2Rd
Distanced	4Rd	2Rd	n/a

Outcome

- Calculate Net Successes
 - Positive results from Bd pool
 - Minus negative results from Rd pool
 - Plus or minus modifiers from the result of their Approach
- Compare
 - Highest wins
 - Ties resolved by Momentum, resolving as 1 pt success
 - Note: A Steal Momentum outcome happens immediately, and will precede this resolution.
 - If loser has <0 net successes
 - <0 successes gives opponent +1 Advantage
- Apply most of the results of the Approach immediately, 'saving' the Advantages to be selected in momentum order

Advantages can now be applied ... TBD resolving in momentum order? or is it logical as the sequence continues

Winner

1. Hit location is determined by the widest, lowest number in the winner's Bd pool
 1. Note: Target Location Advantage can shift the hit location.
 2. Armor/cover/blockage is determined by coverage on any given location
2. Calculate wound points inflicted, calculate the steps in this order
 1. Net Successes
 1. Weapon 'weight' or 'lethality' translates net successes into wounds
 1. Unarmed 1-4 successes = 1(+)-3 or (successes-3), min of 1
 2. Limited 1-3 successes = 1(+)-2 or (successes-2), min of 1
 3. Light 1-2 successes = 1(+)-1 or (successes-1), min of 1
 4. Medium 1:1 success = 1(+)
 5. High/Heavy = 2(+)
 6. Very Heavy = 3(+)
 7. Extreme = 4(+)

2. Plus modifications from Approach outcome
 1. Additional wounds (successes applied in step 1)
 3. Plus Special Impacts damage bonus
 1. ≥Pair of 6s can trigger special weapon damage -> impale or crush etc ==TBC
 4. Apply Hit Location modifiers
3. Reduce by any Block pts
 - 1.
 2. Roll Ad
 1. Note: Parry or Defend Advantages can modify the Ad pool
 3. Add any modifiers from Approach outcome
 4. Reduce Wound inflicted by total Block
 4. Net result is the number of wound points inflicted

Hit Location Table

Widest #	Location	Modifier
. 5 or 6 .	Chest & Shoulders	If width of 5's ≥triple +2(++) wound pts If impact ≥3 then +Stagger(+)
. 4 .	Head	If width of 4's ≥triple +2(+) wound pts +additional Stagger If impact ≥3 before armor then +Stagger(++) If impact ≥opponent's Flesh Bd, then KO
. 3 .	Guts	If width of 3's ≥triple +1(++) wound If impact ≥2 before armor then +Stagger(+)
. 2 .	Legs	If width of 2's ≥quad +2(++) wound pts & Impale/Cut/Cleave capable weapon & grip If impact ≥4 then + Stagger(+)
. 1 .	Arm	Apply max weapon as Medium Damage (1-2 = 1) Any stagger reduced by 1 step

Stagger impact from hit location is determined

- If wound ≥x before armor, AND wound after armor ≥0 then +stagger(+)

Weapon Special Impacts

hit location & effect = narrative opportunity

Pain? Short term but larger Rd impact

- Triggered on ≥pair(+) 5's &/or 6's

Special	Wound & Persistent Rd Effects	None or Soft/Light	Chain or Padded Armor	Hard or Solid Protection
≥Pair 5's or 6's	If >0 wound inflicted...	Soft	Flexible	Hard
. Crush .	Broken/cracked/chipped bone [2Rd]	2(+)Rd	2Rd	1Rd
. Impale .	[+1(+) Wound pt] Weapon stuck - Advantage needed to pull out [0(+)Rd]	1(+) Wound pt 0(+)Rd stuck	o(+) 1(+) Wound pt 1(+)Rd stuck	0(+) Wound pt --
. Cut & Slash .	Persistent large cut/scar [1(+)Rd]	0(+) Wound pt 1(+)Rd	-- 0(+)Rd	-- --
. Cleave .	Deep cut, or severed... ...digit/ear/toe(on a Trip), hand/nose(on Quad), arm/leg(Quin), head!(TBC)	1(++)Rd	1(+)Rd	0(+)Rd
. Stinger .	Damaged nerve/impaired If head hit 2(+) Stagger	0(+)Rd	0(+)Rd max 1Rd	--
. Bash .	Stagger 1(+)			
. Entangle .				
. Parry .	Use weapon/shields parry without an advantage (<u>once</u>) at (Ad)+			

Impact (bullet)

TBD should a weapon effect be applied even if you lose the opposed roll? This will make combat more messy & maybe quicker

If wound damage -> breaks, bruises etc equal Flesh Bd = KO

Stagger Ladder

Staggered is a progression, from Off-balance to KO'ed

Stagers	Stage	Modifier	Status	Special Notes
0	Normal	--	On Feet	

Staggers	Stage	Modifier	Status	Special Notes
1	Off-balance	1Rd	On Feet	
2	Reeling	2Rd	On Feet	
3	On Knees	3Rd	On Knees	Could be bracing, or doubled over (same status and modifier)
4	Floored	3Rd/-3Rd	On Floor	
5	Winded	4Rd/-4Rd	On Floor	Only move to Winded if starting Off of the Floor Unable to Recover footing in next action.
6	KO'd			Only if starting Off of the Floor

- Outcomes can include +Stagger
- Staggers are cumulative over the course of round
 - Note: for an opponent that are large/strong/agile
 - Stagger Bonus -> they can deliver 'double' stagger when an outcome adds +Stagger
 - Stagger Defense -> they require 'double' to stagger them
- Limited/Single/Double
 - Limited - no effect on someone who requires a Double
 - Double - requires additional +staggers to move to Staggered or Reeling (once at Reeling, effectively as Single)

Impact of Different Size Combatants

To Stagger	vs Stagger				
	Limited	Single	Strong	Double	Triple
Limited	No mod	-1	-2	-3	-4
Single	+1	No mod	-1	-2	-3
Strong	+2	+1	No mod	-1	-2
Double	+3	+2	+1	No mod	-1
Triple	+4	+3	+2	+1	No mod

- Since staggers are cumulative across the round, a negative can be overcome with multiple stagger outcomes

Recovery

- Recovering from Stagger
- You can trade momentum for recovering from stagger
- Penalty for each stage

Advantages

- Gained as a result of the width of the main roll
- Modified by the Approach to combat
- Or purchased 1:1 with drama/luck points
- (Ranged only) Can reduce successes by 1 for a Target Location advantage, multiple possible
- Actors get +1 Advantage per round

Name	Cost	Condition	Benefit
Change Weapon Grip	0		
Release Hold	0		
Recover Footing	1	(multiple)	Recover 1 level of Stagger
Spring	2	AGL ≥4 (once)	Recover 3 steps of Stagger in one move, + Momentum +1
Step	1	(multiple)	Move one step closer or further from the opponent
Quick Parry /Block	1	Have weapon or item (Once)	Gain Ad depending on Parry value based on size/grip of weapon or object
Desperate Parry/Block	2	Have weapon or item (Once)	Gain double nAd
Dodge Step	1	(Once)	2Ad
Retreat	1	Be At Distance & not held	Move 'Beyond Reach'
Target Location	1	Melee or Distance (multiple)	move location up or down by 1
Find Weak Point	1	Up Close, stab or thrust attack (once)	-2 Opp Ad (armor only not parry)
Grab & Hold	1	Up Close	
Break Hold	1	Being Held	TBD
Hold to Throw	1	Holding target Target staggered	TBD
Restrain	1	Holding target	TBD
Surprising Action	1 Luck	(once)	Narrate +1 Momentum
Steal Momentum	2		Narrate & Grab momentum (regardless of opponent's level of momentum)

Name	Cost	Condition	Benefit
Stagger	1	Outcome or stagger capable weapon/grip	+Stagger
Shove	1	Not distanced	+Stagger
Trip	2	Trip capable weapon/grip	'Knock to Knees' (stagger 4) Modified by stagger difference
Hook/Beat	1	Hook/Beat capable weapon at effective range (once per opponent)	+1 Momentum
Block Move Closer	1	At Distance, with a Distanced weapon	Cancel a Step move from an opponent
Unarmed Block	1		Block all unarmed damage from one blow
Brace	1		Prepares for and neutralizes a Stagger2 (useful in momentum sequence, doesn't carry to next round)
Withdraw weapon	1	When impaled	
Bind	2	Trained & capable Weapon	TBD - removing primary weapon with your off hand, to allow free strike with your primary - primary to primary, allowing alternative action.
Taunt	1		Aggro an opponent, to select you if there are more than one opponent to choice from
Distract opponent	1		1pt Block next round
Motivate self	1		-1Rd on self for next action
2nd strike (Secondary strike)	2	Trained with Quick weapon or Off Hand (Once) Vs opponents with soft armor on body & limbs	Deal 1pt wound (max)
Counter-punches	1	(multiple)	1st counter-punch -> +stagger 2nd counter-punch -> momentum +1 3rd counter-punch -> deal 1pt wound (max) TBC
<u>Advantages which supported by Luck/DP</u>			
Flowing Strikes (secondary strike(s))	1 Advantage & 1(+) pt Luck	(multiple) Trained & capable Weapon Vs opponent with at least one location	Deal 1(+) 1pt wound(s)

Name	Cost	Condition	Benefit
		with soft or flexible armor on body or limbs	
Master Cut (add to primary strike)	2 & 1(+) pts Luck	Trained & capable Weapon (once)	Add to a successful strike +1(+) wound pt(s) +1(+)Rd persistent wound
Shield Smash (secondary strike)	1 & 1(+) pt Luck	Trained & capable Weapon (once)	Deal max 1pt wound or +Staggers(++)
Riposte (secondary or reaction strike when weapon #stuck)	1 & 1(+) pts Luck	Trained & capable Weapon (Once)	Riposte strikes the chest, armor in that location modifies outcome Deal 1(+)pt wound vs soft or flexible armor Deal 0(+)pt wound to hard armor
Off-hand	1 & 1 pt Luck	Capable weapon + suitable situation	Deal 1pt wound +stagger if greater size difference
Disarm	2 & -1 Momentum		TBD

Grapple

- Grab and Hold -> does location matter?
- Strength & Stamina

Misc Question

Grapple vs Weapon/Ranged

Melee vs Ranged

Multiple Combatants

- You can save/use Advantages from on combat in the other
 - e.g. triggering a Parry vs an unopposed 2nd opponent

TBD - how to soften the impact of unarmed vs limited Flesh points?

Win on momentum -> min 1pt net result

Actor Survival

- Use Luck to save from death
 - 3Rd Cheated Death - 3 month recovery

- Note: knock on into the Skills...
- Actors get a free Advantage -> allowing for more specials, more parry/blocks etc

Armor updated vs 5's & 6's

Missile Combat

- Speed
 - Opposed or unopposed
- Actions
- Aiming Approach
- Advantages
 - Nerve
- Under fire

0(+)... 0,1,2,3

1(+)... 1,2,3,4

0(++)... 0,2,4,6

1(++)...1,3,5,7

Variable Outcome

Advantages

Optional Before roll Steps resolved before rolls, taken in sequence

From script writing

- Consider adding a success for each sequential run of momentum. Then you start to look for reasons and ways to change the impact of momentum.
- Gives fresh opportunity for advantages to redress the balance.
- More about:
 - Stealing momentum
 - Countering momentum
 - Digging deep
 - Finding fresh hope
 - Being encouraged
 - Helping each other

More recovery in the approaches.

